

Creating a Space

PRIMARY TEXT: MEDITATE OR MEMORIZE OPPORTUNITY

In Genesis, God created the space—a beautiful space—and our task was to fill it. Yet humanity filled it with things that didn't fit what the original intent and plan was for creation—the Kingdom.

In Exodus, God says *you* create the space, and I'll fill it. I'll fill it with goodness and justice and rest and all the things that I intended your world and life to be filled with.

We can be pretty good at creating space today, but we have gotten all too good at filling those spaces to a point of near suffocation.

- Working
- Cleaning
- Mowing
- Parenting
- Sitting in traffic
- Podcasting
- Gaming
- Social media
- Binging an entire season of your new favorite show?

**... we have gotten
all too good at
filling those
spaces to a point
of near suffocation**

None of these things, alone, are bad. But we like to use them as distractions, to keep ourselves from even having the time to create space for what will truly fill us up, with what we truly need. We become so busy and overstimulated with all these things that we fill the margins of our lives with endless worry, fret, anxiety, exhaustion, and, eventually, burnout.

**The margins of
our lives were
not meant to
be filled by us.**

The margins of our lives were not meant to be filled by us. When I read a good book, one that stretches me or feels like a warm hug from beyond, I usually end up writing in the margins at least a bit—ask questions, push back at things that seem unsure or I wrestle with, make notes to come back to an idea later, or, one of my favorite notes to make—“I love this.”

When we create space for God in our lives, perhaps leave the margins of our daily walk or spiritual practice attempts open instead of filling it ourselves, God can start to write in those margins. Some of His notes may challenge and stretch us as we strive to practice disciplines that don't come easily. Some of them may just be a giant heart next to the pouring out of our souls through the practices that make us feel human again. One may be a question or conviction to wrestle with or submit to. Another may be Him joining us in praying His own words again and again.

How beautiful to create a space where you have sat in solitude, practiced prayer journaling or fasting, or given in abundance, and to hear God say within those margins:

*I love this.
This is what my Kingdom is about!
THIS is what trusting the Story looks like.
Well done!
I'm still here...*

***How beautiful to
create a space... and
to hear God say...***

We long for those words.
We long for Him. To be close to Him.

So go, try one thing. One manageable thing that can refill or stretch you—or a little bit of both. Let God begin to fill in the margins of your to-do lists and calendars and text messages and emails, and see what happens.

God's right there—so ready to fill that space, to grow in intimacy with you.

PRAYER

*Blessed are you, Lord our God, King of the Universe
for sending us your Spirit to meet with us
in so many sacred ways.
We long for You. To be close to You.*

*Let us not live for our desire to check boxes,
to do more or grow in number—even in Your Name.
Rather, let us slow down, and create space, hold space,
and cherish this space with You.
We long for You. To be close to You.*

*Teach us to pray. Teach us to sit in silence.
Teach us to meditate. To give and receive.
To submit and to serve. To sabbath and celebrate.
We long for You. To be close to You—together.*

*Each day, may we create more space
in our humanity—in our community—
for You to fill with Your Divinity...*

THE FOUR PILLARS

EPISODE 24

BEMA Discipleship is built on four pillars; a **Four-Pillared Perspective** to help us remember **to elevate the words of God** (not ours) and help us identify the principles that we see recurring in the Story of God's people.

Here are some applications for this episode echoing the ideas of the four pillars:



TEXT

What might be important to meditate over within the stories we've read in Genesis and Exodus? What part of this Text challenges you or could you dig deeper into?



COMMUNITY

How does your community practice spiritual disciplines? How might you come alongside one another as a group and also help one another create individual intimacy with God?



DISCIPLESHIP

Who can you bring alongside you to model these spiritual practices? Who could you challenge as Bill challenged Marty? Who have you been discipled by and is there to challenge you in creating space for intimacy with God?



WRESTLING

What are you wrestling with? How to create space in our modern world? Some of the spiritual practices? Past experiences that make you skeptical? Wrestling is good; find someone to talk to and wrestle through it with them.



Are you a music listener?

Listen along to our BEMA Music Playlists on Spotify.

Song suggestions? Send them to bemabesorah@gmail.com.



BEMA SESSION 1



MEDITATION & PRAYER

REFLECTION, APPLICATION & IMPACT

There are three emphases we are always thinking about in terms of application at BEMA. These may be stated explicitly at times, but often we will want you to do the work of finding ways to connect the dots to the things we are learning. Much of this is what makes the work of BEMA distinct as a ministry of Impact Campus Ministries.

CREATING A SPACE SPIRITUAL FORMATION

*We've finally gotten to the episode where we dive into and explain what this idea of spiritual formation is all about! What spiritual practices or disciplines might you need to connect with God? We believe that **if we do our part in creating space for God, He will fill it.** How might the smallest practice fill you with more of Him? What do you need to set aside to create that space? What practice could you refine, pick up again, or challenge yourself to try for the very first time? If you haven't yet, start by creating that space—He will fill it!*

CONSIDERING CAMPUS YOUNG PEOPLE FOCUS

***We believe young adults are shaping the future, and they need to experience God through people like you.** This isn't pressure to save their soul or make a life-altering impact or make them bear good fruit—this is about you making yourself even more available for God to use. Let Him do the heavy lifting. Just let God fill you, and be on the lookout for those young people to show them who God truly is!*

SACRED STATION THEOLOGY OF WORK

*Imagine not filling all the margins in your everyday life; you didn't slow down just to go to church on Sunday (although that's a rush for many of us). Living in intimacy with God is about how you put Him on display, in how you pursue and experience your 9–5. Does your physical work put you in a position to be a walking image of God's love, God's promise? Do you model healthy spiritual practices—that something that makes you different? The way we manage our employees, interact with customers or coworkers, care for our children, or create products can make an impact. It can bear good fruit if you are living in intimacy and creating space for Him. **You are doing a sacred work—no matter where you are**—and God is cheering you on.*